

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

- A. Being African or Hispanic American
- B. A lower level of education
- C. Living in a city
- D. Being married
- E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
- F. High intake of saturated fats
- G. Older age
- H. Eating fish
- I. Being a smoker
- J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

<tool_call> reasoning process here

To determine which factor is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's , we evaluate each option based on established medical and epidemiological research .

- A . Being African or Hispanic American â Studies show that certain racial and ethnic groups , including African Americans and Hispanic Americans , may have higher risks due to socioeconomic , environmental , and genetic factors . So , this is associated with increased risk , not decreased .
- B . A lower level of education â Lower educational attainment is linked to increased risk of Alzheimer 's , possibly due to reduced cognitive reserve . So , this is associated with increased risk .
- C . Living in a city â Urban living has mixed associations , but some studies suggest urban environments may have higher pollution and stress , potentially increasing risk . No strong evidence supports decreased risk .
- D . Being married â Multiple studies show that marriage is associated with a lower risk of dementia and Alzheimer 's , possibly due to social support , mental stimulation , and reduced loneliness . This is a well-documented protective factor .
- E . Having a family history of Alzheimer 's â This is a known genetic risk factor , so it increases risk .
- F . High intake of saturated fats â Linked to increased inflammation and cardiovascular disease , both of which are risk factors for Alzheimer 's .
- G . Older age â Age is the strongest risk factor for Alzheimer 's ; risk increases with age .
- H . Eating fish â Fish , especially fatty fish like salmon , are rich in omega - 3 fatty acids , which are associated with a lower risk of cognitive decline and Alzheimer 's . This is supported by research .
- I . Being a smoker â Smoking is linked to increased risk of Alzheimer 's due to vascular damage and inflammation .
- J . Drinking alcohol regularly â Excessive or regular alcohol consumption is associated with increased risk ; however , moderate intake may have some protective effects , but it's not consistently protective and can be harmful .

Now , among the options , both D (being married) and H (eating fish) are associated with decreased risk . However , the question asks for "which of the following factors " â implying one best answer .

Between D and H , " eating fish " is a dietary factor with strong evidence for neuroprotection via omega - 3 s . " Being married " is also protective , but the evidence is more about social and psychological factors .

However , " eating fish " is more directly linked to brain health and neuroprotection through biological mechanisms , and is consistently associated with reduced cognitive decline .

But note : " being married " has been shown in multiple large studies (e.g. , the National Study of Health and Aging) to reduce dementia risk by up to 20 â 30 % , and is a well-established protective factor .

However , the strongest and most consistent evidence for a *decreased risk* factor is " eating fish " due to its direct neuroprotective role .

But wait â let's check the most robust and direct evidence .

Actually , multiple large studies (e.g. , from the Nurses ' Health Study , NHANES) show that dietary patterns rich in fish and omega - 3 s are associated with lower risk of cognitive decline and Alzheimer 's .

Still , " being married " is a strong social factor .

But the question is which is associated with decreased risk â and both D and H are valid .

But the options are mutually exclusive â only one answer is to be selected .

Looking at the list again , the most consistently supported and widely recognized protective factor from lifestyle â especially in dietary context â is eating fish .

However , in some sources , being married is highlighted as a strong protective factor .

But in a 2016 study in JAMA Neurology , marital status was linked to reduced risk of dementia .

Still , the most direct biological protective factor is eating fish .

But let's check if " eating fish " is a direct answer â yes , it is .

Now , is there a better one ?

Wait â option H : " Eating fish " â yes , it's supported .

But is it as strong as being married ?

Actually , both are valid . But the question may be testing knowledge of lifestyle factors .

However , in